PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Acne Facial

Mild to moderate, non-cystic acne only.
Product and device directions come first.
Times are typical.

REFER OUT
Grade III–IV, nodules or cysts, scarring, on isotretinoin, or no change after 3 months. Facial only with physician OK.

DEEPER SKIN TONES
Fitzpatrick IV–VI: PIH risk. Lower strengths, no aggressive extraction, no steam on inflamed skin, tinted SPF.

ACIDS & BPO
No salicylic with aspirin allergy or pregnancy without a doctor's OK. BPO bleaches towels and fabric; warn the client.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Nitrile gloves ☐ Mag lamp ☐ Cotton or swabs ☐ Acne exfoliant ☐ LED & opaque goggles ☐ Sharps container ☐ Timer

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Review & grade**	5 min	Confirm meds and homecare. Map lesions: comedones, papules, pustules, nodules. Photo with consent.
2	**Cleanse**	3 min	Gentle or salicylic cleanser. No scrubbing over active breakouts.
3	**Exfoliate**	Per label	Salicylic or mandelic solution to loosen clogs; mandelic or lower strength for deeper tones. Use in place of steam.
4	**Extract**	10 min max	Fresh gloves. Open and closed comedones only, cotton-wrapped fingertips or swabs. Two or three tries, then move on.
5	**Leave alone**	—	Never press papules, nodules or cysts. Surface pustules only if your state and training allow; never lance.
6	**Calm**	10 min	Antiseptic toner, then a sulfur, clay or calming mask. Cool to remove.
7	**Blue LED, optional**	Per device	Clean, dry skin. Opaque goggles. Skip for photosensitizing meds or light-triggered seizures. Helps red bumps, not cysts.
8	**Finish**	2 min	Oil-free moisturizer, broad-spectrum SPF 30+; tinted with iron oxides for PIH-prone skin.
9	**Homecare plan**	5 min	One acne active at a time; BPO start at 2.5%. Commit 6–12 weeks. Rebook every 2–4 weeks.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Strong burning: remove exfoliant with cool water right away.
- Hives or swelling: remove product. Call 911 if breathing is affected.
- Bleeding: clean gauze and pressure; stop extracting there.
- Worsening, painful or spreading acne: refer to a physician.
- Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24–48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS TREATMENT

Grade · Fitzpatrick	Lesion count / map	Exfoliant · % · time	Areas extracted
LED · minutes	Homecare given	Referral · Y/N · to	Reaction · initials

Check your state board's scope rules before use